phones', computers' and other digital media where payments can be authorized by typing a code, touching a finger or batting an eyelid.

The second major policy agenda is for RBI to combine the three payment platforms—Immediate Payment System (IMPS), National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT) and Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS)—into a single platform that functions 24/7 and processes payments instantaneously instead of batch processing, which the present NEFT system currently does. The three platforms may remain only in name for categorizing accountholders. This platform can compete with NPCI as a public-sector platform.

The other major reform agenda is to introduce competition to NPCI. RBI has already started the process of licencing a few more National Umbrella Entities (NUEs) to establish platforms like UPI. These entities were to be primarily non-bank entities while banks could also be among their promoters. RBI has put this proposal on hold for the time being, which is not a good move. These five to six NUEs are necessary to make India's payment system most efficient, competitive and the best in the world. Customers would be the real winners.

The investment universe is very large.

Digital technologies are transforming investments. While large equity and debt investment securities have got dematerialized and the entire space has been consequently digitalized, both equity and debt investment instruments are tightly regulated and not opened to fintech by the respective regulators, RBI and SEBI. Investment in mutual funds (MFs) and small investments in new pension products have seen limited opening to fintech in terms of some intermediary services provided. Some start-ups have come up in the field, though the bulk of the investment business is still routed through traditional banking channels, albeit in digital format. Fixed deposits, insurance products and retirement funds like EPFO and NPS still remain in the physical ecosystem although electronic copies of fixed